ART

ARTISTIC **EPICENTRE**

The **India Art Fair**'s 16th edition is its most ambitious yet with 118 exhibitors and a range of conversations on the arts of the future

Taking place at New Delhi's NSIC Exhibition Grounds from February 6 to 9, the 16th edition of India Art Fair (IAF) will feature a record 118 exhibitors, 78 galleries and an expanding design section with 11 renowned studios from across the world. "Following last year's success, the Design section returns with a stronger focus on craft-led innovations and will incorporate disciplines such as furniture, textiles and product design, bridging the gap between art and design," says fair director Jaya Asokan. "Look out for Vikram Goyal, the design studio based out of New Delhi, and working with brass as the primary material," she adds.

The fair will take place at New Delhi's NSIC Exhibition Grounds from Feb. 6 to 9

Among other highlights are new works by Pakistani-American sculptor Huma Bhabha and Colombian artist Oscar Murillo, presented by David Zwirner, and fair veterans like Anish Kapoor with Galleria Continua and Chinese artist Ai Weiwei with Lisson Gallery. IAF continues to diversify its outdoor projects with artists like Paris-based Claire Fontaine's LED installation inspired by their storied 'Foreigners Everywhere' series, or even a Mohd Intiyaz exploring themes of discrimination, resilience and belonging through the lens of his childhood memories with an evocative sculpture.

"Asim Waqif's 'MAKE-SHIFT' is another standout—a monumental mobile artwork crafted from a second-hand cement truck and metal scrap, embodying the rawness of material and the unpredictability of improvisation," says Jaya. Then there is BMW India and IAF's 'The Future is Born of Art' commission-winning artist duo Dennis Peter and Yash Chandak, who will present 'Biolume', an immersive experience that draws inspiration from bioluminescence.

The fair's mainstay, however, continues to be its conversations, with the 'Growing Focus' talks series amplifying creative voices from South Asia. Speakers like Sangita Jindal, president of Art India and chairperson of the JSW Foundation; Hans Ulrich Obrist, artistic director at the Serpentine Gallery, London; and artist duo Thukral and Tagra will lead discussions on cultural cross-pollination, grassroots movements in the arts, and the impact of technology. For the past five years, IAF has also been a springboard for collectors below the age of 45. Now in its sixth edition, the Young Collectors' Programme, curated by Wribhu Borphukon, widens the purview of the module to grant budding collectors access and insight into contemporary art practices.

Jaya underlines why the event has continued to foster an ever-evolving dialogue for over a decade and a half now. "It is a rare venue," she says, "where thousands of artists, galleries and art lovers come together to form connections over their love for the arts." ■

–Arshia







VIVID DISPLAY
Clockwise from above, Anish Kapoor's 'Apple Magenta mix 2 and Black Mist', Huma Bhabha's 'Maybe Nothing Maybe Everything', a brass work by Vikram Goyal